

Figure I.2 *Jam, minaret of Jam (c. 1180) [*sic*], general view from northeast, with steep valley in background. © Photograph Josephine Powell c. 1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

Jam-Firuzkuh in central Afghanistan (Figure I.2) long remained enigmatic due to its isolated location and lack of palatial remains; even more so was the Shansabanis' exclusively funerary presence in the strategically and commercially important region of Qandahar (Figure I.3). Their material footprint in the Bamiyan valleys (Figures I.4 and I.5; Figure I.22) – unexamined as a whole, until now (see Chapter 3) – is admittedly difficult to discern, given the mixture of reused and newly constructed traces, both on a significant scale. Even the momentous Shansabani conquest of Ghazna and Bust-Lashkari Bazar in *c.* AH 568–569/1173 CE resulted largely in renovations of existing palatial areas (Figure I.6), with only punctually